

Annotation Guidelines for Sentiment Re-Annotation

These guidelines direct the independent, blind sentiment annotation of a sample from the KurdiSent corpus (Sorani tweets). How reliable and reproducible are the assigned sentiment labels? The task corresponds to that of the original paper's three sentiment classes (positive, negative, neutral) at the tweet level.

Please annotate naturally and to the best of your judgment according to the following rules. The goal is **not** to guess an "official" label, but to independently determine the sentiment actually expressed by the text.

1 · Basic Rules

- Each item is evaluated **individually and independently**, based solely on the displayed text.
- Do **not use external information**: do not search for the original tweet, do not research context, do not assume a category.
- Do **not discuss with third parties** while the annotation is ongoing.
- Evaluate **the sentiment expressed in the text**, not your own opinion on the topic.
- Do **not retroactively adjust** earlier labels to appear "consistent" with later ones. One pass, item by item.

2 · The Three Labels

Positive: The text expresses a positive attitude, emotion, or evaluation from the author: joy, affection, praise, gratitude, agreement, hope, optimism, blessings.

Negative: The text expresses a negative attitude or emotion, criticism, anger, sadness, fear, complaint, condemnation, disappointment, insult.

Neutral: **No clear sentiment** is expressed: a pure factual statement, information, question, or description. The author's attitude is not identifiable. Even a factually formulated report about an inherently positive or negative *event* is neutral, as long as the text itself does not convey an evaluation.

There are exactly these three options. Each text must be assigned to one of the three. For difficult cases (sarcasm, mixed sentiment, hard to read) use the **notes field** to mark such cases.

3 · Decision Process

Go through the questions in this order and stop at the first match:

1. **Is an identifiable attitude/emotion expressed?** No (pure factual statement/question/info) -> **Neutral**.
2. **Can the attitude be clearly assigned to a polarity?** Yes -> **Positive** or **Negative**.
3. **Are both polarities present?** Choose the **predominant** one. If they are perfectly balanced and no overall attitude is identifiable -> **Neutral**.
4. **Irony/Sarcasm?** Label according to the **intended** polarity. If the intention is not reliably identifiable, choose the most plausible of the three and **mark the case in the notes field**.

4 · Difficult Cases

News / reporting texts. Evaluate the **author's attitude**, not the valence of the reported event. A neutrally formulated factual report about a tragic or joyful event is **Neutral**. Only evaluative or emotional language (e.g., به‌داختموه "unfortunately", emotive adjectives, outrage, cheering) makes the text positive/negative. *This rule is the most important operational definition, the original paper does not specify it, which is why the author's standpoint is deliberately authoritative here.*

Sarcasm / Irony. If the intended statement is identifiable, label according to the **intended** polarity. If the intention cannot be reliably reconstructed, choose the most plausible option and note "Sarcasm, uncertain" in the notes field. Never label solely based on surface words.

Mixed Sentiment. Praise **and** criticism: choose the **predominant** side. Only if both are perfectly balanced and no overall attitude is discernible -> **Neutral** (Note: "mixed").

Greeting, gratitude, and blessing formulas. Frequent in this corpus (e.g., سوپاس "Thank you", دمست خوش "well done/thanks", blessings). These generally express gratitude/goodwill -> **Positive**, provided there is no contrary context.

Questions / rhetorical questions. Generally **Neutral**, unless they carry a clear evaluative load (e.g., outraged rhetorical question -> Negative).

Emojis, Emoticons, Numbers. If present in the text, they may be used as sentiment indicators.

Very short / hard to read texts. Choose the most plausible of the three options and mark the case in the notes field (e.g., "incomprehensible" or "too little context"). This keeps it traceable in the evaluation.

5 · Working in Label Studio

- Select **exactly one** label per item (mandatory field).
- Please use the optional **notes field** for difficult cases (sarcasm with uncertain intention, mixed sentiment, hard to read).
- The items appear in a mixed order. **Nothing** can be derived from the position of an item, do not label based on it.

- Press **Submit** after each item to save the annotation

6 · Examples

Text	Label	Justification
ترسی سەرھەڵدانی توندوتیژی ڕمگەزپەرستی لە بەریتانیایە لە ئارادایە بەداخەوه	Negative	Fear + بەداخەوه = clear negative evaluation.
زۆر سوپاس، دەست خۆش	Positive	Gratitude
ژمارەیکە نوێی گۆڤاریک کەوتە بەردەستی خوێنەرانی	Neutral	Pure factual report, no author evaluation.

These guidelines serve the purpose of an independent quality check. Systematic differences between this annotation and the published labels are an expected outcome of the study please label freely according to these rules, regardless of how the original dataset might have been decided.